HAROUNA SAHO

Beyond the Space In Two

Aisling Gallery, The Study at Yale
October 22 – November 22, 2026

Opening Reception: Friday, October 30, 6–8 PM

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Artist Statement

I’m drawn to presence more than argument. My figures aren’t responding to a history, they’re simply here, and I use the techniques of painting freely.

My subjects are family and friends, drawn from photographs, including images from The Gambia. I equate the body to a mask. In many West and Central African traditions, a mask isn’t a symbol of something beyond itself, it’s a vessel for it. I think of what a figure carries as a kind of light, not literal and not reserved for a chosen few. The paintings are where it gets remembered. Movement runs through all of it. I grew up in the United States with a home I could only reach through family, memory, and photographs, so I have always lived in two places at once. The distance between where I come from and where I am now is something I carry, and the paintings are where I work through it.

The photographs are fragments of a place I know but can’t always stand in. When I paint from them, I’m not documenting home, I’m traveling there and back. That is why I think of these worlds as third spaces. Each work is real and invented at once, pushed through the cartoons and anime I grew up on, where power becomes visible. They are neither memory nor invention, but both, and neither here nor there. They hold the reality I’m in now and the one I’m reaching toward, side by side. I rarely begin with a meaning. I work intuitively, in a state of play, where results stop mattering and thinking less allows full presence. A meaning always arrives. I set blue against yellow, stillness against movement. Old and new sit together, ancestral masks, oil paint, animation, a continuity from where I come from to where I am. Without play, none of this happens.

About the Artist

Harouna Saho is a painter and printmaker raised in Norman, Oklahoma, with roots in The Gambia. He is a senior at Yale University, where he studies computer science and art. He started building things through robotics in middle school, and that habit of constructing whole worlds carries into his painting.

Saho works across oil, acrylic and relief printmaking, in a practice centered on the figure and always evolving.

In summer 2026 he took part in the Printmaking Residency at Anderson Ranch Arts Center in Snowmass Village, Colorado, working with artist Yashua Klos. There he developed his woodblock practice, including *Homage*, on view in this exhibition. *Beyond the Space In Two* is his first solo gallery exhibition.



Continuum, 2025

Oil on canvas, 48 × 36 in, unframed

$5,000

Purchase inquiries: harouna.saho@yale.edu



What Remains, 2025

Oil on canvas, 24 × 36 in, unframed

$3,550

Purchase inquiries: harouna.saho@yale.edu



Offering, 2025

Oil on canvas, 24 × 36 in, unframed

$3,550

Purchase inquiries: harouna.saho@yale.edu



See No Evil, 2026

Acrylic on canvas, 12 × 12 in, unframed

$1,000

Purchase inquiries: harouna.saho@yale.edu



Hear No Evil, 2026

Acrylic on canvas, 12 × 12 in, unframed

$1,000

Purchase inquiries: harouna.saho@yale.edu



Speak No Evil, 2026

Acrylic on canvas, 12 × 12 in, unframed

$1,000

Purchase inquiries: harouna.saho@yale.edu



See No Evil, Hear No Evil, Speak No Evil, 2026

Triptych. Acrylic on canvas, three panels, 12 × 12 in each, unframed

$2,700 as a set (individually $1,000 each)

Purchase inquiries: harouna.saho@yale.edu



Unheard, 2024

Acrylic on canvas, 12 × 12 in, unframed

$1,000

Purchase inquiries: harouna.saho@yale.edu



Homage, 2026

Woodblock print, ink on cotton, 32 × 48 in, unframed

$4,750

Purchase inquiries: harouna.saho@yale.edu